

The River Answers Back: A Signal

河流的回应：一个信号

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

They had just deleted a system for remembering too much; the river did not care what they had learned. The eighth arc began with a slight **shake** in the base of the field station, and within an hour the river was pouring over the road. “We **need to define** the flood level, not merely to **desire** it,” the director said. **Almost** every gauge was reading a number that was **nearly** the same as the last, and none of them was **consistent** with the water in the yard.

A **substantial** part of the old model was built on a **photographic** memory of ten dry years. “The **yield** is not **proportional** to the rain,” a **leading** hydrologist said. “The main product of a bad model is **suspicion**.” He watched the water with a **grin** that was **almost fearful**.

The **unique** thing about the district was its **aptitude** for holding water: **ample** ponds, a **sizable** canal, and a **spontaneous** habit of keeping the ditches clear. “You cannot **eliminate** a flood,” he said. “You can **irrigate** a field with it.” A **weird, dreamy light** on the water made the whole scene feel **illusory**, and the team could not **render** it in numbers.

While the engineers sweated over the **diagnosis**, a **legendary** boatman diagnosed the problem in one sentence: the river was **capable** of a third channel, and the district had withdrawn from it. “**Incidentally**, that is a **rendering** of the same story my grandfather told,” he said, and he was **thirsty** for someone to believe him.

The report was **shaky** and the agreement was **agreeable** only in name. “Add the local readings and cut the modelled ones,” Maya said. “The **implicit** assumption is that the river is **incidental** to our data. It is not.” **Approximately** a hundred people had signed, and they could **agree** on one point: their accounts were more **consistent** than the instruments.

Down at the field station, the team began to pass the old model through a smaller filter: even a ten per cent error was too much when a full street was under water, and less would have to mean more. The director left the door open for the way back, and nobody closed it. The term was **significant**: a **similar** event had happened once before, and nobody had written it down.

中文翻译

他们刚刚删掉了一个记得太多的系统；而这条河并不在乎他们学到了什么。第八段弧线以野外站地基的一阵轻微震动开始，一小时内河水就漫过了道路。“我们需要给洪水水位下一个定义，而不是只去渴望它，”主管说。几乎每一个水位计读出的数字都与上一个差不多，而没有哪一个与院子里的水情一致。

旧模型相当大的一部分建立在十年干旱的照相式记忆上。“产量并不与降雨成比例，”一位主要的水文学家说，“一个糟糕模型的主要产物是怀疑。”他带着一种几乎可以说是恐惧的咧嘴笑看着水面。

这个地区独特之处在于它蓄水的天资：充足的池塘、一条相当大的水渠，以及一种自发保持沟渠畅通的习惯。“你无法消除洪水，”他说，“你可以用它来灌溉一块田。”水面上那怪异而梦幻的光让整个场景显得像是幻觉，而团队无法把它换算成数字。

当工程师们为诊断而满头大汗时，一位传奇般的船夫用一句话诊断了问题：这条河有能力形成第三条河道，而这个地区已经从那里退了出来。“顺便说一句，这正是我祖父讲过的同一个故事的翻译，”他说，而他渴望有人相信他。

报告是摇晃不稳的，“一致”也只是名义上的一致。“把本地的读数加进去，把建模的数字砍掉，”曼雅说，“那个含蓄的假设是：河流对我们的数据只是附带的。它不是。”大约有一百人签了名，而他们能在一点上取得一致：他们的叙述比仪器更连贯。

在野外站里，团队开始让旧模型通过一个更小的过滤器：当一整条街都在水下时，哪怕百分之十的误差也太大，而“更少”必须意味着“更多”。主管为返程留了门开着，谁也没有去关。这个学期是重要的：类似的事件从前发生过一次，而没有人把它写下来。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
need ni:d POS: n	n. 需要, 必须, 缺乏; vt. 需要, 必需; vi. 贫困, 有必要; aux. 需要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a condition requiring relief; n. anything that is necessary but lacking; v. have or feel a need for
while hwaɪl POS: n	n. 一会儿, (一段)时间; conj. 当...的时候, 虽然; vt. 消磨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period of indeterminate length (usually short) marked by some action or condition
almost 'bɪlməʊst POS: adv	adv. 几乎, 差不多 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r (of actions or states) slightly short of or not quite accomplished; all but
agree ə'ɡri: POS: vi	vi. 同意, 赞成, 应允, 适合; vt. 承认, 认定, 同意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be in accord; be in agreement; v. consent or assent to a condition, or agree to do something; v. show gramma...
similar 'sɪmələ POS: a	a. 相似的, 类似的; n. 相似的东西 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by correspondence or resemblance; s. (of words) expressing closely related meanings
nearly 'ni:li POS: adv	adv. 几乎, 密切地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r (of actions or states) slightly short of or not quite accomplished; all but; r in a close manner
significant sig'nɪfɪkənt POS: a	a. 重要的, 有效的, 有含义的, 暗示的, 值得注意的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. important in effect or meaning; s. fairly large; a. too closely correlated to be attributed to chance and th...
shake ʃeɪk POS: n	n. 摇动, 震动; vt. 摇动, 动摇, 使震动, 挥舞; vi. 震动, 发抖, 动摇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move or cause to move back and forth; v. move with or as if with a tremor; v. undermine or cause to waver; v. ...
define di'faɪn POS: vt	vt. 定义, 规定, 使明确; [计] 定义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give a definition for the meaning of a word; v. determine the nature of; v. show the form or outline of
substantial səb'stænʃəl POS: n	n. 重要材料(或事物), 有实际价值的东西; a. 实质上的, 物质的, 有内容的, 结实的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having a firm basis in reality and being therefore important, meaningful, or considerable; a. having substa...
desire di'zaɪə POS: n	n. 欲望, 要求; vt. 想要, 请求; vi. 渴望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the feeling that accompanies an unsatisfied state; n. an inclination to want things; n. something that is de...
leading 'li:diŋ POS: n	n. 领导, 指挥, 神示, 铅板; a. 领导的, 主要的, 在前的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. indicating the most important performer or role; s. greatest in importance or degree or significance or ach...
unique ju:'ni:k POS: a	a. 独一无二的, 独特的, 稀罕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (followed by 'to') applying exclusively to a given category or condition or locality; s. highly unusual or...
eliminate i'limineɪt POS: vt	vt. 除去, 排除, 剔除, 消除 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. kill in large numbers; v. remove from a contest or race; v. remove (an unknown variable) from two or more eq...
capable 'keɪpəbl POS: a	a. 有能力的, 能的, 能干的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (usually followed by 'of') having capacity or ability; s. possibly accepting or permitting; a. (followed by...
pour pɔ: POS: n	n. 流出, 倾泻, 骤雨; vt. 倒, 灌, 注, 倾泻, 诉说, 倾吐; vi. 倾泻, 蜂涌而来, 下大雨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to run; v. move in large numbers; v. flow in a spurt; v. supply in large amounts or quantities
withdraw wɪð'drɔ: POS: vt	vt. 撤回, 取回, 撤消, 使撤退, 拉开, 移开; vi. 撤退, 离开 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. pull back or move away or backward; v. remove (a commodity) from (a supply source)
consistent kən'sɪstənt POS: a	a. 一致的, 坚持的, 并立的, 坚固的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (sometimes followed by 'with') in agreement or consistent or reliable; s. the same throughout in structure...
approximately ə'prɒksɪmətli POS: adv	adv. 大约, 大致, 近于; [经] 大约, 近似 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. (of quantities) imprecise but fairly close to correct
yield ji:ld POS: n	n. 生产量, 投资收益; vt. 出产, 给予, 让出, 放弃, 使屈服; vi. 出产, 屈服, 投降, 倒塌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an amount of a product; v. be the cause or source of; v. give in, as to influence or pressure; v. bring in
grin ɡrɪn POS: n	n. 露齿笑; v. 露齿而笑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to draw back the lips and reveal the teeth, in a smile, grimace, or snarl

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
suspicion sə'spiʃən POS: n	n. 怀疑, 觉察, 嫌疑; [法] 怀疑, 疑心, 嫌疑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being suspected; n. being of a suspicious nature
render 'rendə POS: vt	vt. 回报, 给予, 付给, 汇报, 提出, 舍弃, 反映, 表示, 表演, 致使, 执行, 实施; vi. 给予补偿; n. 交纳, 打底 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a substance similar to stucco but exclusively applied to masonry walls; v. cause to become; v. give or suppl...
diagnosis ,daɪəg'nauzɪs POS: n	n. 诊断; [计] 诊断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. identifying the nature or cause of some phenomenon
weird wiəd POS: a	a. 怪异的, 超自然的, 不可思议的; n. 命运, 预言, 符咒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. strikingly odd or unusual; some weird effect of shadow"— Bram Stoker
sweat swet POS: n	n. 汗, 汗水, 水珠, 焦急; vi. 出汗, 渗出, 冒出水气, 结水珠, 烦恼, 懊恼; vt. 使出汗, 流出, 榨出, 使汗流浹背 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. condensation of moisture on a cold surface; v. excrete perspiration through the pores in the skin
diagnose 'daɪəgneuz POS: v	v. 诊断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. determine or distinguish the nature of a problem or an illness through a diagnostic analysis; v. subject to...
legendary 'ledʒendəri POS: a	a. 传说的, 传奇中说的, 传奇般的, 传说中的, 著名的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. so celebrated as to having taken on the nature of a legend
implicit im'plɪsɪt POS: a	a. 暗示的, 含蓄的, 固有的, 绝对的; [经] 不讲明的, 含蓄的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. implied though not directly expressed; inherent in the nature of something; s. being without doubt or reser...
incidentally ,ɪnsɪ'dentəli POS: adv	adv. 伴随地, 偶然, 顺便 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. of a minor or subordinate nature
spontaneous spɒn'teɪniəs POS: a	a. 自然的, 自发的, 未经琢磨的; [医] 自发的, 特发的, 自生的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. happening or arising without apparent external cause
photographic ,fəʊtə'græfɪk POS: a	a. 照相的, 摄影用的, 详细记录的, 逼真的, 酷似的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to photography or obtained by using photography; s. representing people or nature with the exactne...
fearful 'fiəfʊl POS: a	a. 可怕的, 恐怕的, 担心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. experiencing or showing fear; s. extremely distressing; s. timid by nature or revealing timidity
proportional prə'pɔ:ʃənəl POS: a	a. 比例的, 相称的; n. 比例项 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the quantities in a mathematical proportion; s. properly related in size or degree or other measurab...
ample 'æmpl POS: a	a. 大量的, 充足的, 丰富的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. more than enough in size or scope or capacity; s. affording an abundant supply; s. fairly large
shaky 'ʃeɪki POS: a	a. 震动的, 摇晃的, 动摇的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. vibrating slightly and irregularly; as e.g. with fear or cold or like the leaves of an aspen in a breeze
sizable 'saɪzəbl POS: a	a. 相当大的, 大小相当的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s fairly large; s large in amount or extent or degree
agreeable ə'ɡriəbl POS: a	a. 令人愉快的, 同意的; [医] 佳适的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. conforming to your own liking or feelings or nature; s. prepared to agree or consent
incidental ,ɪnsɪ'dentəl POS: a	a. 附带的, 偶然的, 容易发生的; n. 附带事件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an item that is incidental; a. (sometimes followed by `to') minor or casual or subordinate in significance...
thirsty 'θɜ:sti POS: a	a. 口渴的, 渴望的, 干燥的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. needing moisture; a. feeling a need or desire to drink; s. able to take in large quantities of moisture
rendering 'renderɪŋ POS: n	n. 翻译, 表现, 描写, 表演, 打底, 透视图 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a coat of stucco applied to a masonry wall; n. perspective drawing of an architect's design; n. giving in ac...
aptitude 'æptɪtju:d POS: n	n. 资质, 才能, 自然倾向; [医] 资质, 才能 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. inherent ability
dreamy 'dri:mi POS: a	a. 空幻的, 梦想的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. dreamy in mood or nature; s. lacking spirit or liveliness

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
illusory i'lju:səri POS: a	a. 产生幻觉的, 幻影的, 错觉的; [法] 因错觉产生的, 虚幻的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s based on or having the nature of an illusion
irrigate 'irigeit POS: vt	vt. 灌溉, 冲洗伤口, 使清新; vi. 灌溉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. supply with a constant flow or sprinkling of some liquid, for the purpose of cooling, cleansing, or disinfecting